Food Remedy API
Competitive App Research: Nosher [RE021]

Prepared For: Food Remedy API
Team Author: Zhi Wang
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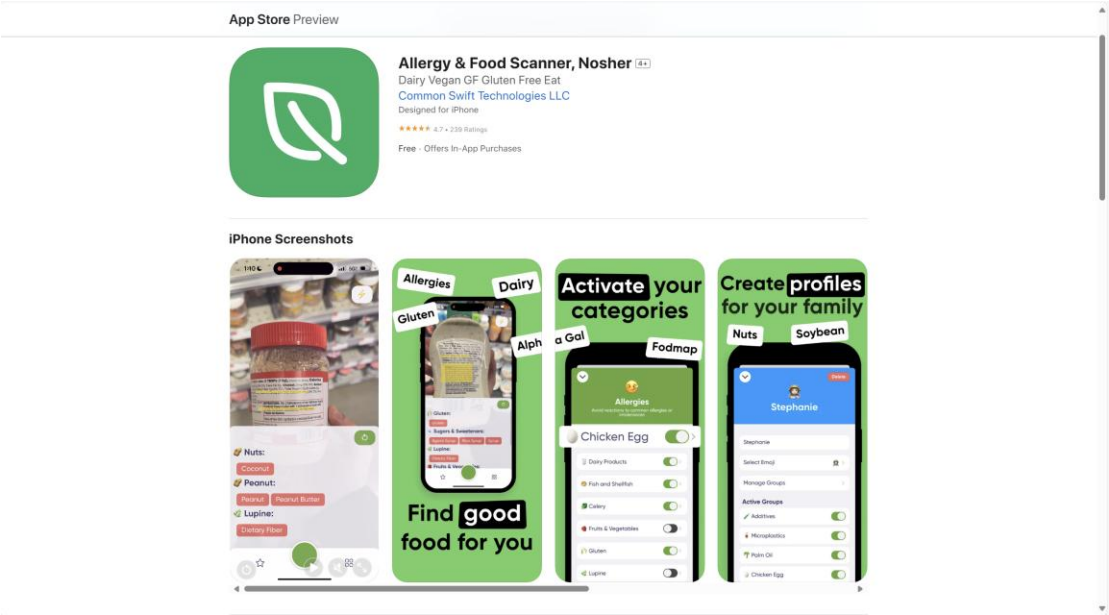
1. Introduction

This research focuses on *Nosher*, a mobile application designed to help users identify allergens, additives, and other food content by scanning product ingredient labels. The purpose is to review its gluten-specific detection, scanning interface, warning display, and allergen customization features, with the goal of identifying improvements for our own allergy tagging system.

2. Core Features

During testing, Nosher's scanning process was fast and responsive. The gluten detection feature worked reliably — once a product containing gluten was scanned, the app highlighted the relevant ingredients immediately. The scan interface is simple, with a clear viewfinder and a quick transition to results. There was no noticeable lag between scanning and receiving the allergen report.



3. Supporting Features

Nosher offers multiple dietary categories such as gluten-free, dairy-free, vegetarian, vegan, and low-additive diets. Setting up a profile was straightforward, and it allowed me to select specific dietary preferences. The household profile option made it possible to store different sets of dietary requirements for multiple people, which was useful when scanning for more than one person. The product comparison tool also worked well, allowing side-by-side viewing of nutritional content and allergen presence.

4. Extended Advantages

While primarily focused on allergens, the app also flagged other ingredients such as palm oil, seed oils, microplastics, and certain food additives. This extra layer of detection added value for users who are also concerned about general food quality and sustainability. There is also a cosmetic product scanning feature, which can detect potentially harmful ingredients in personal care products.

5. Platform Coverage and User Impressions

Nosher is available on both iOS and Android. In my experience, the app ran smoothly on mobile, with no crashes or freezes during multiple scans. The overall navigation between different features, such as switching from food scanning to product comparison, felt intuitive. Notifications for new features were also visible within the app, showing ongoing updates.

6. Warning Display and Allergen Customization

When a scanned product contained gluten, the warning was displayed prominently, using both color highlights and text indicators. It was easy to spot without having to read through the entire ingredient list. The allergen preferences section allowed me to add or remove other allergens, such as dairy or nuts, so the app could tailor its alerts to my needs. Adjusting these settings only required a few taps, making customization quick and user-friendly.

7. Recommendations for Improvement of Our Allergy Tagging System

Based on this experience, the following improvements could be applied to our own scanner:

- Customizable Allergen Alerts: Provide a simple way for users to choose which allergens trigger warnings.
- High-Visibility Warnings: Use strong color contrasts and icons to ensure allergen alerts stand out clearly.
- Multiple Profiles: Allow different profiles for individual users within the same account, similar to Nosher's household feature.
- Expanded Detection: Consider adding detection for non-allergen ingredients that users may want to avoid, such as certain oils or additives.

Conclusion

Nosher combines quick and accurate allergen detection with flexible customization and additional ingredient alerts. Its simple interface, clear warning system, and multi-profile support make it a strong example for improving our own allergy tagging system. Adopting similar approaches could enhance both the usability and the appeal of our product.